

Mac Addicts

Hell's Angels is not the ultimate cult, in case you thought it was. You probably haven't met Mac owners yet. These are people absolutely passionate about what they are doing. They do not tolerate insults against a Mac easily, and you can't blame them. They are trying to do things differently, after all!

It's not common to overhear a conversation about an iMac in your college corridor. If you have worked on or owned a Mac, you'd know exactly what we mean—the exalted status, the enthusiasm brimming over when words issue from a frothy mouth talking animatedly about the latest iMac wonder...It's rare to see this in India because

to get into this silly, spasmodic state, you have to be a part of the Mac addicts club. From the graceful simplicity of the iPod to the easy-to-install AirPort to the formidable OS X—Apple's idea behind all products and designs is a very simple and basic one: mix beauty with performance. An iMac is not a machine, it is a treat. Hence the addiction.

5 Simple, yet elegant

Apple made the GUI. A well-designed, neat, and easy graphical user interface makes all the difference between instant liking and disliking. An iMac is easy; it has won awards for best design and the designers have kept the utilitarian aspect in mind. You won't get lost in there trying to figure out what you were doing in the first place.

Chances are, you won't be put off by the new iMac. One wonders what the purpose of computing is if it's not keeping it easy and simple, yet elegant.

6 Easy to setup

It's easier and faster to set up a Mac than a Windows machine. This has been proved more than once in real time tests where the Mac took lesser time to set up and run than a Windows machine. The proprietary architecture adopted by Apple makes it easier and quicker for a user to set it up. The OS comes preinstalled and the connection points for the peripheral devices are clearly marked so that you can put a Mac together all by yourself.

7 It's cool

A community or a cult is always close-knit. Likewise, Mac users have, and will claim, more affinity within themselves than ordinary Windows users. In other words, it's cool to own a Mac. First of all, you've got to reach that position when you can afford it, and secondly, it looks so good and handles even better! What else does cool mean?

8 Plug and play

The Mac offers superb plug-and-play capabilities—no missing drivers, no resetting jumpers or bothersome IRQ conflicts, nothing—thanks to the complete control and clearly defined vision that Apple has for the architecture.

Apple had plug-and-play on their machines since the mid 1980s (Microsoft had plug-and-play only Windows 95 onwards). This early advantage has helped them perfect the technology to a very fine tune—you can hear it almost. Just plug in any number of devices to a Mac and get away with it—adding (or removing) hardware is not a problem with Macs.

9 It's virusproof

A Mac is comparatively more secure; it has limited vulnerability to viruses as compared to Windows. Mac users have been protected from most of the chaos wreaked by virulent viruses worldwide. The main reason is that there aren't many viruses, worms or Trojans around that target the Macintosh OS. The OS is very secure, as in, it's not lucrative enough for hackers to make viruses for the Mac.

10 Great multimedia capabilities

Games and multimedia look and sound great on a Mac. Though there are fewer games available for the Mac platform, the most popular games nowadays have also been ported to the Mac platform. The games that are available on both platforms (Windows and Mac) run really beautifully on a Mac. You get extremely realistic graphics and sound reproduction on Macs, which makes multimedia and movie playback quite an experience.

ILLUSTRATION: Ram

